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GNIOT Institute of Management Studies – PGDM (Batch 2022-24)

(TRIMESTER – III) END TERM EXAMINATION, APRIL - 2023

INDUSTRIAL RELATIONS AND HR LEGISLATIONS

[Time: 2 Hours 30 Minutes]

[Maximum Marks: 100]

INSTRUCTIONS:

- (i) There are THREE sections in this question paper.
- (ii) Attempt questions from each section as per the directions.
- (iii) Make suitable assumptions wherever necessary.

SECTION-A

(Short Answer Type Questions, do not exceed 100 words)

Q.1. Write short notes on the following:

(10×3=30)

- (a) Define “Factory” under Factory Act 1948.
- (b) “Collective bargaining is an important aspect of industrial peace” Comment.
- (c) What do you mean by employee discipline?
- (d) Highlight major reasons of industrial dispute.
- (e) Write five main Problems of trade union.
- (f) Write function of trade union relating to union members.
- (g) According to the IR mention different actors of Industrial Relations.
- (h) Write objectives of Industrial Relation.
- (i) Mention major components of standing order act.
- (j) Write a note on Medical officer and conciliation officer.

SECTION-B

(Long Answer Type Questions)

Attempt all the following questions:

(4×10=40)

Q.2. (a) “Industrial relations are as old as industry itself”. Discuss this statement under the concept of IR.

OR

- (b) What the pre-requisites of successful IR in any nation also explain the role of government in establishment of peace in Industry.

Q.3. (a) Discuss the objectives, scope and important provisions of the Employee’s State Insurance Act, 1948.

OR

- (b) Discuss the importance of collective bargaining as the method of regulating relations between employers and employees.

Q.4. (a) Explain the role and importance of Trade Union in establishment of industrial peace in India.

OR

- (b) Explain the main features and provisions of Factories act. 1948.

Q.5. (a) Write short notes on EPF, Arbitration and Unitary Approach.

OR

- (b) How grievance handling procedure helps in dealing labour problems? Discuss.

SECTION-C

Q.6. Attempt all parts of the following:

(2×15=30)

Helen Bowers was stumped. Sitting in her office at the plant, she pondered the same questions she had been facing for months: how to get her company's employees to work harder and produce more. No matter what she did, it didn't seem to help much.

Helen had inherited the business three years ago when her father, Jake Bowers, passed away unexpectedly. Bowers Machine Parts was founded four decades ago by Jake and had grown into a moderate-size corporation. Bowers makes replacement parts for large-scale manufacturing machines such as lathes and mills. The firm is headquartered in Kansas City and has three plants scattered throughout Missouri.

Although Helen grew up in the family business, she never understood her father's approach. Jake had treated his employees like part of his family. In Helen's view, however, he paid them more than he had to, asked their advice far more often than he should have, and spent too much time listening to their ideas and complaints. When Helen took over, she vowed to change how things were done. In particular, she resolved to stop handling employees with kid gloves and to treat them like what they were: the hired help.

In addition to changing the way employees were treated, Helen had another goal for Bowers. She wanted to meet the challenge of international competition. Japanese firms had moved aggressively into the market for heavy industrial equipment. She saw this as both a threat and an opportunity. On the one hand, if she could get a toehold as a parts supplier to these firms, Bowers could grow rapidly. On the other, the lucrative parts market was also sure to attract more Japanese competitors. Helen had to make sure that Bowers could compete effectively with highly productive and profitable Japanese firms.

From the day Helen took over, she practiced an altogether different philosophy to achieve her goals. For one thing, she increased production quotas by 20 percent. She instructed her first-line supervisors to crack down on employees and eliminate all idle time. She also decided to shut down the company softball field her father had built. She thought the employees really didn't use it much, and she wanted the space for future expansion.

Helen also announced that future contributions to the firm's profit-sharing plan would be phased out. Employees were paid enough, she believed, and all profits were the rightful property of the owner—her. She also had private plans to cut future pay increases to bring average wages down to where she thought they belonged. Finally, Helen changed a number of operational procedures. In particular, she stopped asking other people for their advice. She reasoned that she was the boss and knew what was best. If she asked for advice and then didn't take it, it would only stir up resentment.

All in all, Helen thought, things should be going much better. Output should be up and costs should be way down. Her strategy should be resulting in much higher levels of productivity and profits.

But that was not happening. Whenever Helen walked through one of the plants, she sensed that people weren't doing their best. Performance reports indicated that output was only marginally higher than before but scrap rates had soared. Payroll costs were indeed lower, but other personnel costs were up. It seemed that turnover had increased substantially and training costs had gone up as a result.

In desperation, Helen finally had hired a consultant. After carefully researching the history of the organization and Helen's recent changes, the consultant made some remarkable suggestions. The bottom line, Helen felt, was that the consultant thought she should go back to that "humanistic nonsense" her father had used. No matter how she turned it, though, she just couldn't see the wisdom in this. People worked to make a buck and didn't want all that participation stuff.

Suddenly, Helen knew just what to do: She would announce that all employees who failed to increase their productivity by 10 percent would suffer an equal pay cut. She sighed in relief, feeling confident that she had finally figured out the answer.

6(a). How successful do you think Helen Bowers's new plan will be?

6(b). If you were Helen's consultant, what would you advise her to do?